

important for you and important for your survival, you make time for,” Peyton-Carrillo said.

I think many people don’t have the luxury to fight the status quo, but he replied, “I think the majority of people don’t have the luxury to live in the status quo.”

You’ve made it this far into the book. You know by now that marginalized people have been punished financially throughout history—women, people of color, LGBTQ people, disabled people, lower-class people, and those who are all of the above. There’s the wage gap (which is much worse for women of color and trans women and those who are both), the lack of parental leave (which is much worse for women of color), the inability of women to get a credit card until the 1970s and even then, only with their husband’s signature. (Everything is horrible!)

There are many, many deeply systemic hurdles to evening the playing field. In the illuminating 2015 book *2 Dollars a Day: Living on Almost Nothing in America*, researchers Kathryn Edin and H. Luke Schaefer profiled families who, forced off government assistance and unable to find jobs, had no other choice but to live on that tiny titular amount a day. The two researchers found that in 2011, more than 4 percent of children in America were living on the same amount of money a middle-class person might spend at a toll booth. Schaefer’s research counted family income, other cash income in the form of gifts from family and friends, odd jobs, private pensions, and any random money the family made. “The results of Schaefer’s analysis were staggering,” they wrote in their book. One and a half million families—almost 3 million children—were living on that metric of \$2 a day per person.

A June 2017 article in the *Denver Post* revealed that “nowhere in America can a full-time minimum wage worker afford to rent a two-bedroom apartment.” *Nowhere*. Even downsizing to a one-bedroom, Tracy Jan wrote in the *Post* piece, will only get you so far on minimum wage. Many people, even those getting welfare checks while working, still can’t make enough to survive. The *Denver*